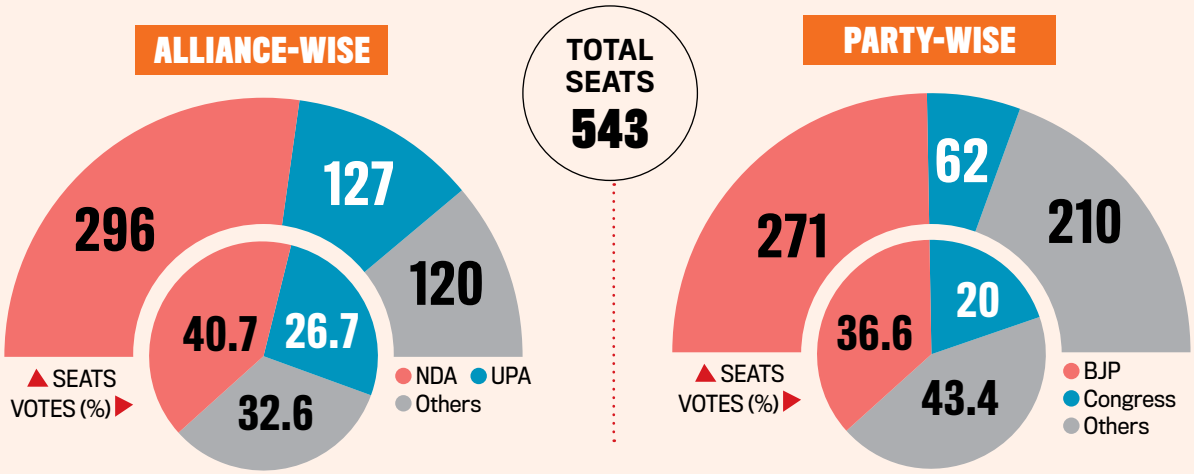
INDIA TODAY MOOD OF THE NATION POLL 2022

PROJECTED RESULTS IF LS ELECTIONS WERE HELD TODAY



NDA: Bharatiya Janata Party, Jana Sena Party, Asom Gana Parishad, United People's Party Liberal, Janata Dal (United), Hindustani Awam Morcha, Vikassheel Insaan Party, Rashtriya Lok Janshakti Party, Jannayak Janta Party, All Jharkhand Students Union, Republican Party of India (Athawale), National People's Party, Mizo National Front, Nationalist Democratic Progressive Party, Nagaland People's Front, All India N.R. Congress, Punjab Lok Congress, Sikkim Krantikari Morcha, All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam, Pattali Makkal Katchi, Tamil Maanila Congress, Indigenous People's Front of Tripura, Apna Dal (Sonelal)

UPA: Indian National Congress, Goa Forward Party, Jammu & Kashmir National Conference, Jharkhand Mukti Morcha, Indian Union Muslim League, Revolutionary Socialist Party, Kerala Congress, Revolutionary Marxist Party of India, Nationalist Congress Kerala, Kerala Congress (Jacob), Shiv Sena, Bahujan Vikas Aaghadi, Prahar Janshakti Party, Swabhimani Paksha, Peasants and Workers Party of India, Nationalist Congress Party, Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam, Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam, Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi

OTHERS: Aam Aadmi Party, All India Forward Bloc, All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen, All India TrinamoolCongress, All Jharkhand Students Union, Amma Makkal Munnettra Kazagam, Biju Janata Dal, Bahujan Samaj Party, Bodoland People's Front, Communist Party of India, Communist Party of India (Marxist), Gondwana Gantantra Party, Gorkha Janmukti Morcha, Indian National Lok Dal, Janta Congress Chhattisgarh, Janata Dal (Secular) Jammu and Kashmir People's Democratic Party, Kerala Congress (Mani), Makkal Nidhee Maiam, Rashtriya Lok Dal, Rashtriya Lok Samta Party, Shiromani Akali Dal, Sikkim Democratic Party, Samajwadi Party, Telegu Desam Party, Telangana Rasthra Samithi, YSR Congress Party, Independents and Others

Modi's personal popularity sees an uptick this MOTN, with 62.8 per cent of respondents rating his performance as good to outstanding, compared to 54 per cent in August 2021. This is still some distance from the phenomenal 78 per cent approval that the prime minister garnered in August 2020, at the peak of the first wave of Covid. However, it does not diminish their trust in Modi's ability to deliver.

The widening chasm between his popularity and that of Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, his closest contender from the Opposition, only reinforces the notion. Asked who is best suited to be the next prime minister, 52.5 per cent respondents voted for Modi and only 6.8 per cent for Rahul—a yawning gap of 46 per cent. In August 2021, that gap had narrowed to 14 per cent, with Modi polling 24 per cent and Rahul 10 per cent. The ratings for the NDA government's performance too have improved, with 58.7 per cent saying they were satisfied or very satisfied compared to 53 per cent in August 2021.

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LOSS OF SEATS PROJECTED FOR THE NDA SHOULD LS POLLS BE HELD TODAY, FROM 352 IT WON IN 2019

What explains this booster dose of confidence for Modi and his government? One clear reason seems to be the massive Covid vaccination drive that crossed over 1.64 billion doses on January 18, with more than 70 per cent of India's 940 million adult population now fully vaccinated. That has fostered a sense of security in the face of the pandemic in addition to saving lives and livelihoods.

It is this endorsement that the MOTN reflects when it lists the NDA government's